

Sauti — Uganda Youth Internet Governance Platform

Team Digital Voices Uganda · UYIGF 2026 Hackathon Submission

Live prototype: <https://sauti-digital-uganda.vercel.app>

1. The problem we are solving

Most young Ugandans live online — WhatsApp, TikTok, mobile money, loan apps — but very few know how internet governance actually affects them. Who decides AI rules? What does the Data Protection Act mean when an app asks for your SMS? When a fake government notice goes viral, how do you know what to trust?

The gap is not just awareness. Youth are rarely heard when policy is written. Forums like UYIGF and UIGF exist, but there is no simple way for a student in Kampala (or anywhere else) to learn, practice spotting harms, and have their views collected into something a policymaker can actually use.

We built Sauti — Swahili for "voice" — to close that gap. Not another quiz app that stops at "well done." A tool that teaches, tests real judgment, and turns youth input into a live governance brief.

2. What Sauti does

Sauti is a mobile-first web platform with four connected steps:

- **Learn** — Short cards on AI governance, the Data Protection Act, the Computer Misuse Act, cybersecurity, and digital rights. Each card uses a real Uganda example, with Luganda subtitles and optional audio read-aloud.
- **Spot It** — Youth judge realistic scenarios: WhatsApp forwards, fake MoMo SMS, AI-cloned politician audio, loan apps that harvest contacts, and leaked private photos. We teach the TRACE method (Trust the source, Red flags, Ask & verify, Consent & data, Evidence) so spotting harms becomes a habit, not trivia.
- **Voice** — Five quick pulse polls on live issues: AI content labelling, app data transparency, digital literacy in schools, privacy penalties, and youth representation at UYIGF.
- **Brief** — All poll answers aggregate in real time. Anyone can view live charts and download a Youth Digital Governance Brief as PDF, or copy formatted text for UIGF 2026 thematic input.

3. Why we think this is different

Honest answer: many hackathon teams will build "learn + quiz + chatbot." We chose a harder problem — producing output. When a young person answers a poll on Sauti, their response is stored in our database, reflected on the Brief screen within seconds, and included in the downloadable PDF. That is real consultation data, not a slideshow.

We also added Governance Pulse: a curated tracker pointing youth to active UIGF processes, UYIGF events, and official UCC channels — so they know where governance is happening, not just what it is.

4. Technology (kept simple on purpose)

We used React and Tailwind for the frontend (hosted on Vercel), Node/Express for the API (hosted on Render), and Neon Postgres for the database. No chatbot API on stage — we did not want something that could fail or hallucinate during a live demo. The brief is generated from live SQL queries and simple

template logic. Code is open at <https://github.com/edyeluandrew/Sauti-Digital-Uganda>.

5. Who this is for — and what comes next

Sauti is for Ugandan youth under 30: students, young professionals, school clubs, and anyone who wants to move from scrolling to contributing. If we win incubation support, we would run Sauti sessions before each UYIGF cycle — same platform, fresh polls, new brief each year.

We are proud that this is built by youth, for youth, with Uganda at the centre — not generic "digital citizenship" content copied from elsewhere. Sauti is our voice. We hope it helps others find theirs.

Team: Team Digital Voices Uganda

Demo: <https://sauti-digital-uganda.vercel.app>

API health: <https://sauti-digital-uganda.onrender.com/api/health>